statement

The while loop executes the statement when the expression is evaluated to true. The statement is a simple statement terminated by a semicolon or a compound statement enclosed in curly brackets.

whilestm.php

```
<?php

$i = 0;

while ($i < 5) {
    echo "PHP language\n";
    $i++;
}

?>
```

In the code example, we repeatedly print "PHP language" string to the console.

The while loop has three parts: initialization, testing, and updating. Each execution of the statement is called a cycle.

```
$i = 0;
```

We initiate the $i variable. It is used as a counter in our script.

```
while ($i < 5) {
    ...
}
```

The expression inside the square brackets is the second phase, the testing. The while loop executes the statements in the body until the expression is evaluated to false.

```
$i++;
```

The last, third phase of the while loop is the updating; a counter is incremented. Note that improper handling of the while loop may lead to endless cycles.